Commissioner to India Ashraf Jehangir Qazi, New Delhi demanded that Pakistan crack down on all Lashkar and JeM activities, arrest the groups' leaders and freeze their financial assets.[53]

India also launched a massive military mobilization known as Operation Parakram. Skyrocketing India-Pakistan tensions threatened to escalate into a war between two nuclear powers, and immediately hampered American efforts in Afghanistan. The Taliban had formally surrendered the week prior to the attacks, but fighting raged on. In particular, the al-Qaeda leadership and hundreds of hardened militants were holed up at Tora Bora. The small number of US Special Forces operators on the ground were directing massive air assaults against the militants at Tora Bora, including Osama bin Laden. But the US did not have enough troops in the Afghan theater to head off militants fleeing across the Durand Line and so Pakistani soldiers were being called on to seal the border. Forces from the Pakistan Frontier Corps were near Tora Bora on the Pakistani side of the border, but not nearly in sufficient strength to carry out the job assigned to them.[54] The Parliament attack occurred just as additional troops from the Pakistan army were moving into position. As India went on a war footing and massed troops along the border, the additional Pakistani forces intended to reinforce the Pakistan-Afghan border were deployed instead to the eastern border with India. Musharraf has claimed that Pakistani forces arrested more than 200 militants retreating from Tora Bora.[55] Yet many more escaped in the days after the Parliament attack, possibly including Osama bin Laden.[56] According to the aforementioned report, which recounted US efforts to manage the crisis, substantial roundups of al-Qaeda operatives occurred along the Afghanistan border in late December. However, similar dragnets did not take place for another two years following the redeployment of Pakistani troops.[57]

Because India's war-fighting doctrine at the time called for a major troop build-up, this provided Pakistan time to respond in kind. A dangerous game of brinkmanship ensued as the two countries engaged in what became the biggest military concentration along their border in years. However, the time it took India to mass troops also provided a window of opportunity for the international community to become involved and push for a diplomatic solution. Whether or not this was New Delhi's intention remains an open question. US assessments at the time were divided between those who